Every Moment a Prayer: Learning Duas Through Stories

Fay's Faithful Reminders

Every Moment a Prayer: Learning Duas Through Stories

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Bismillah Before We Begin

The sun was shining brightly at the beach as Asma, Yusuf, Hamza, Fatima, Bilal, and Zayd raced towards the sand with shovels and buckets in hand. Their mission? To build the biggest sandcastle anyone had ever seen.

"I'm going to dig the moat!" Hamza announced, waving his shovel like a sword.

"I'll build the tallest towers!" Asma said, her eyes gleaming with excitement.

"We need a big gate for the castle!" Bilal suggested, already gathering the sand in his bucket.

Zayd, the youngest, stared at the pile of sand with wide eyes, clutching his bucket. He was determined to help, but he wasn't sure what to do.

"Let's get started!" Yusuf called out, ready to scoop the sand into the foundation.

Just as everyone was about to dig in, Fatima suddenly held up her hand. "Wait! We forgot something!"

The others stopped and looked at her in confusion. "What did we forget?" Asma asked, glancing around to see if they had left behind a toy.

Fatima smiled and said, “We forgot to say ‘Bismillah’ before starting.”

“Oh, right!” Zayd said, his face lighting up in realization. “Mom always says to start everything with ‘Bismillah’!”

Yusuf scratched his head. “Why do we have to say it before building a sandcastle, though?”

Fatima explained, “Saying ‘Bismillah’ means we are asking Allah to bless whatever we do. It’s like inviting Him to be a part of our sandcastle adventure. And when we start with His name, everything turns out better!”

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيْمِ

The children exchanged glances, feeling the excitement building up again, but this time with a new sense of purpose.

“Okay, let’s all say it together,” Asma said.

The group gathered around the empty spot where their castle would soon stand, and in unison, they said, “Bismillah!”

As soon as the words left their lips, they got to work. Hamza dug the moat faster than ever before, while Asma shaped the towers with perfect precision. Bilal carefully sculpted the gate, and even Zayd found his place, collecting tiny pebbles to decorate the castle walls.

Time flew by, and before they knew it, the sandcastle was complete. It stood tall and proud, with smooth walls, towering peaks, and a deep moat. It was their best creation yet!

Just then, a gust of wind blew, but the sandcastle stood firm.

“Look! Even the wind couldn’t blow it away,” Hamza exclaimed, amazed at their sturdy creation.

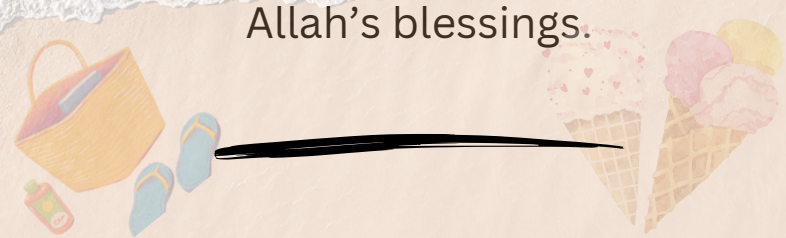
Fatima smiled, knowing in her heart that their success wasn’t just because of their hard work but also because they had started with “Bismillah.”

“This is the best castle we’ve ever made!” Zayd said, beaming with pride.

Yusuf nodded and added, “I guess saying ‘Bismillah’ really does make a difference.”

As they stood back to admire their sandcastle, Fatima turned to her friends and said, “Remember, whether we’re building sandcastles or doing anything else, we should always start with ‘Bismillah.’ It makes everything better.”

And with that, the friends sat down, watching the waves hit each other, with ice creams in their hands feeling happy and content, knowing that they had built something special—with Allah’s blessings.

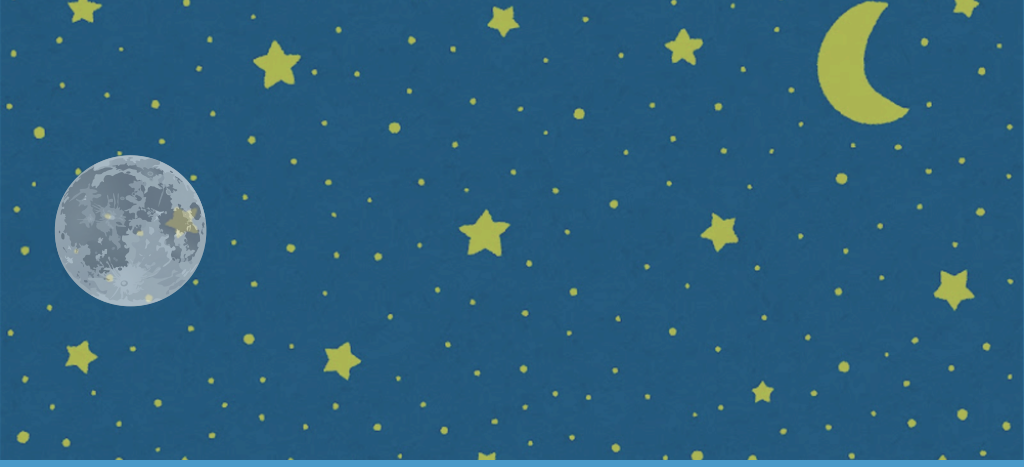


Morning and Night with Asma

It was almost bedtime, and Asma was in her room, folding her pajamas when her mother came in, holding her little brother's hand.

"Time to get ready for bed, Asma," her mother said with a smile.

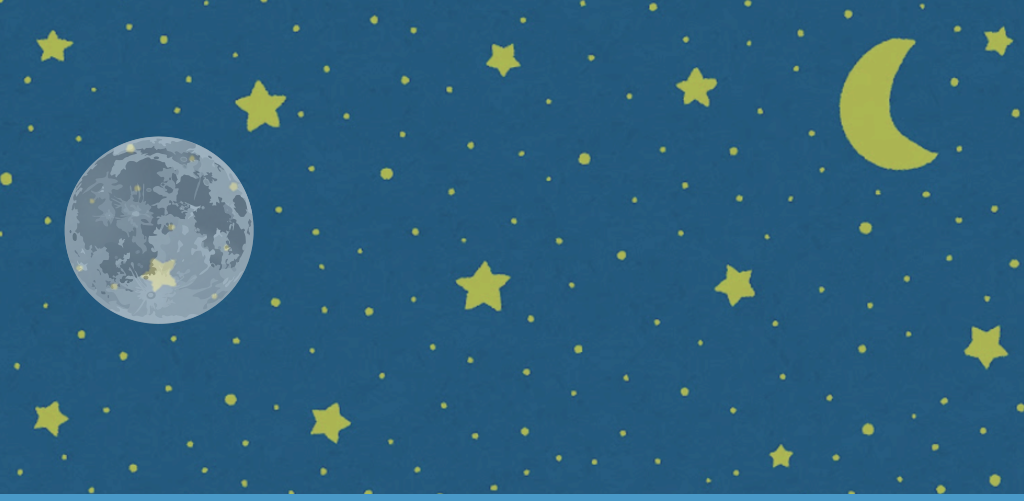
Asma nodded and placed her pajamas on the bed. She noticed her little brother, Bilal, yawning as he climbed into his bed across the room. "Mama," Asma said thoughtfully, "isn't there something we should say before we go to sleep?"



Her mother's face brightened. "That's right, Asma! There's a special dua we say before bed. It's a way to ask Allah to protect us while we sleep."

Asma sat on her bed, intrigued. "What's the dua, Mama?"

Her mother sat down beside her, gently stroking her hair. "We say:
Allahumma bismika amutu wa ahya.
It means, '**O Allah, with Your name, I die and live.'**
When we sleep, it's a little like death, and when we wake up, it's like being given a new life. So we say this dua to remind ourselves that everything is in Allah's hands."



Asma nodded, repeating the words slowly: **“Allahumma bismika amutu wa ahya**.” She felt a warm sense of peace wash over her.

“Very good, Asma,” her mother praised. “Now, let’s say it together before you go to sleep.”

Asma and her mother both whispered the dua, and Asma lay back, feeling safe under her cozy blanket.

The next morning, sunlight peeked through Asma's curtains. She stretched her arms and smiled, remembering the new day Allah had given her. Then, she quickly sat up. "Mama! What about the dua for waking up?"

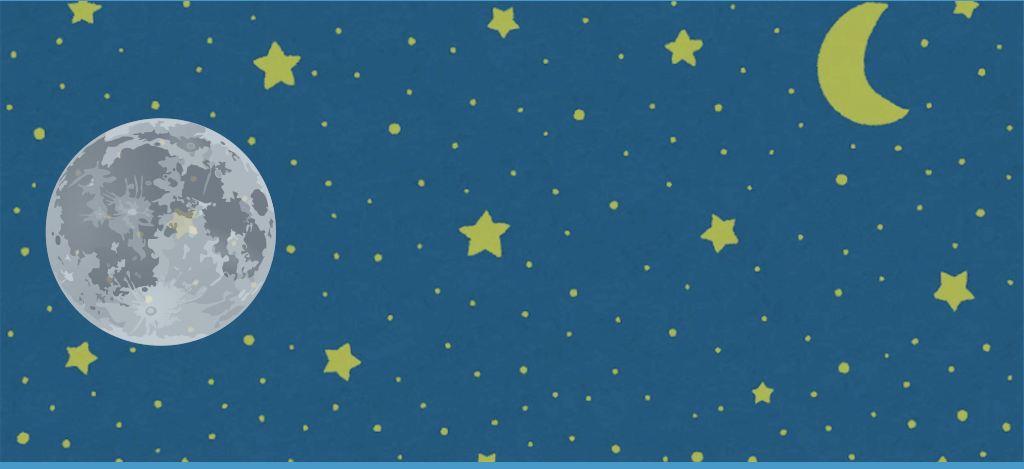
Her mother came into the room, smiling. "I was hoping you'd remember," she said. "When we wake up, we say:
Alhamdulillahi allathee ahyana ba'da ma amatana wa ilayhin-nushoor.
It means, '**All praise is for Allah who gave us life after causing us to die, and to Him is the return**.'
It's how we thank Allah for giving us another day to live."

Asma repeated the words with her mother, slowly understanding the meaning. “So, we’re thanking Allah for waking us up?”

“That’s right,” her mother said. “Every morning is a blessing, and this dua helps us start our day by thanking Allah.”

Asma grinned, feeling excited to use the dua every morning. Then, she had an idea. She glanced over at her little brother, Bilal, who was still snuggled in his bed.

“Mama,” Asma said, turning to her mother, “can I teach Bilal the duas too? He’s little, but I think he’ll understand.”



Her mother smiled proudly. “That’s a wonderful idea, Asma. You can teach him just like I taught you.”

Later that evening, as the family got ready for bed, Asma sat beside Bilal’s bed. “Bilal,” she said softly, “do you want to learn something special?”

Bilal’s sleepy eyes blinked open, and he nodded.

“We say this before we go to sleep,” Asma explained, repeating the night dua carefully. Bilal tried his best to repeat the words after her, and Asma smiled, knowing she was helping him learn something important.

“And in the morning,” she added, “we say a different dua to thank Allah for waking us up. I’ll teach you that one when we wake up tomorrow, okay?”

Bilal nodded again, yawning as he snuggled into his blanket.

Asma lay down in her own bed, feeling proud and happy. Not only had she learned something new, but she was also helping her little brother remember Allah, too. Before closing her eyes, she whispered the dua: **Allahumma bismika amutu wa ahya,** and drifted off to sleep with a heart full of peace.

The Forgotten Dua

It was a bright and cheerful afternoon when Asma invited her friends over to play. As soon as Yusuf, Hamza, Fatima, Zayd, and Bilal arrived, they all gathered in the living room, excited to share stories and play games.

"Asma!" Fatima called out. "Guess what? I've learned some new duas!"

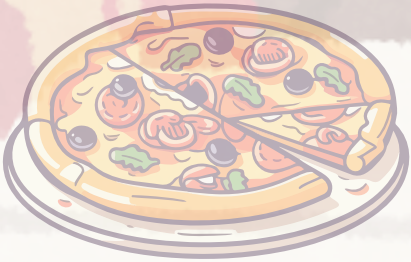
Asma's eyes lit up. "Me too! I learned the duas for waking up and going to bed," she said proudly. "My mom taught me, and I even taught my little brother Bilal."

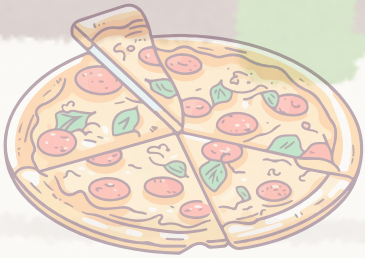
Hamza, Zayd, and Yusuf nodded in agreement. “We’ve learned them too,” said Hamza. “I say them every day!”

Asma grinned. “Isn’t it nice? I feel safe when I say the dua before bed, and in the morning, it’s like I’m starting the day with Allah’s blessings.”

The aroma of freshly baked pizza filled the room, and the children gathered around the table eagerly.

"Asma, I’m so hungry!" Fatima said, her eyes wide as she stared at the pizza.





Yusuf nodded. "Me too. Let's eat!"

Asma's mom brought out the pizza, smiling at the excited faces. "Before you all start, don't forget the dua," she reminded them.

The children began reciting the dua before eating: "Bismillah wa barakatillah."

But Asma was so hungry, she grabbed a slice before remembering to say the dua. She hesitated, feeling a little embarrassed, but quickly took a bite. Just then, Hamza noticed and said with a grin, "Hey, Asma, you forgot to say Bismillah!"

Asma's face turned red. "Oh no, I did! What should I do?"

Yusuf smiled and said, "It's okay. If we forget, we can say a special dua after we start eating. My mom taught me this one."

Asma leaned in, eager to learn. Yusuf recited:
Bismillahi awwalahu wa akhirahu, which means, "**In the name of Allah, in its beginning and in its end."**

Asma repeated it, feeling grateful. "Thank you, Yusuf! I didn't know there was a dua for when you forget."

Everyone said the dua together, and then they happily dug into their pizza. The room filled with laughter and the sounds of munching as they enjoyed their meal, remembering to thank Allah.

When they were done eating, Fatima spoke up. “There’s one more dua we should say now that we’re finished. It’s to thank Allah for the food.”

Asma nodded, remembering what her mom had taught her before. Together, the group recited the dua:
Alhamdulillah allathee at’amana wasaqana waja’alana minal Muslimeen, which means, “**Praise be to Allah who has fed us, given us drink, and made us Muslims.”**

Asma felt happy inside. Not only had she enjoyed a fun day with her friends, but she also learned something new. She smiled at Yusuf, grateful for the reminder.

The rest of the day was filled with laughter, games, and sharing stories, but Asma knew that what made the day truly special was remembering Allah, even in the little things like eating.

The End

Hamza's Special Protection

Hamza stood in front of the bathroom door, staring at the handle. The wind howled outside, for the past few days, he had felt uneasy every time he entered the toilet. It was a strange feeling—something that made him nervous, even though he couldn't explain why.

He took a deep breath and pushed the door open, stepping inside quickly. His heart raced a little, but he didn't know why. "Why do I always feel scared in here?" Hamza thought to himself as he washed his hands. He was too embarrassed to talk about it, but later that evening, Hamza tugged on his dad's sleeve.

“Dad” Hamza began, “I’ve been feeling a little scared when I go into the toilet. I don’t know why, but I just feel... weird.” Hamza confessed

His dad knelt down and gave him a comforting smile. “That’s okay, Hamza. There’s a special dua we say before entering the bathroom that gives us protection. Did you know that?”

Hamza shook his head. “A dua for the toilet?”

“Yes, son,” his dad said with a gentle smile. “The toilet is a place where we need protection from anything harmful,

so we say this dua:
Allahumma inni a'udhu bika minal khubthi wal khaba'ith.

It means, ‘**O Allah, I seek refuge in You from the male and female devils.’”**

Hamza listened carefully. “So, saying the dua protects us while we’re inside?”

His dad nodded. “Exactly. It helps protect us from anything harmful. And do you know how we should enter the toilet?”

Hamza thought for a moment but wasn’t sure. “How?”

We should always enter with our left foot," his dad explained, "and when we leave, we step out with our right foot and say the dua for leaving:
Ghufranaka Alhamdulillah illadhi adhhaba anni al-adha wa 'aafaanee

It means, "**(O Allah) I seek forgiveness and pardon from You".**
All Praise be to Allah, who has taken away from me discomfort and granted me relief".

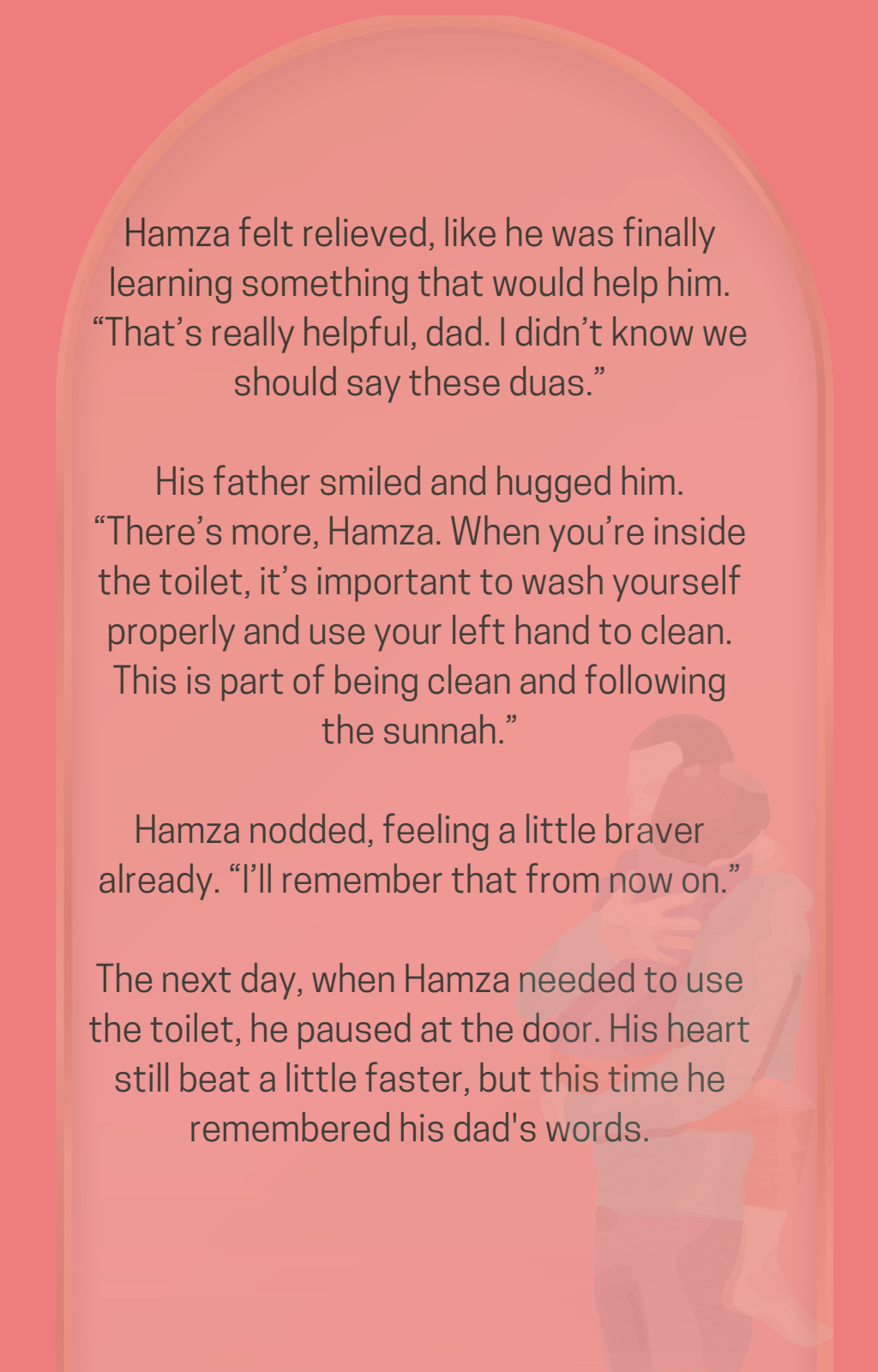
This reminds us that even in simple things like using the toilet, we should ask for Allah's help and forgiveness.

Hamza felt relieved, like he was finally learning something that would help him. “That’s really helpful, dad. I didn’t know we should say these duas.”

His father smiled and hugged him. “There’s more, Hamza. When you’re inside the toilet, it’s important to wash yourself properly and use your left hand to clean. This is part of being clean and following the sunnah.”

Hamza nodded, feeling a little braver already. “I’ll remember that from now on.”

The next day, when Hamza needed to use the toilet, he paused at the door. His heart still beat a little faster, but this time he remembered his dad's words.



“**Allahumma inni a'udhu bika minal khubthi wal khaba'ith,**” he whispered softly, stepping in with his left foot.

He did everything carefully, remembering to wash with his left hand as his dad had taught him. When he finished, Hamza left the toilet, stepping out with his right foot. “**Ghufranaka Alhamdulillah illadhi adhhaba anni al-adha wa ‘aafaanee,**” he said, feeling proud.

That night, as Hamza sat with his mom and dad, he smiled. “dad, I don’t feel scared anymore! Saying the duas really helped.”

His dad beamed. “I’m so proud of you, Hamza. Remember, whenever you feel scared or unsure, there’s always a dua to help you. Allah is always with us.”

Hamza felt a warm sense of peace inside. He had learned an important lesson—not just about the duas, but about trusting in Allah to protect him, even in the smallest moments.

The End

Fatima's Gift of Love

Fatima sat at the kitchen table, watching her parents as they busily prepared dinner. Her father was setting the table while her mother stirred a large pot on the stove. Fatima thought about how much they did for her and her siblings—cooking, cleaning, taking care of them every day.

As the evening went on, Fatima couldn't stop thinking about it. She wanted to do something special to show her parents how much she appreciated them, but she didn't know what.

Later that night, Fatima sat with her eldest sister, Zainab, who was reading a book. "Zainab, I've been thinking," Fatima began. "Our parents do so much for us. I want to give them something special, but I don't know what would be the best thing."

Zainab looked up and smiled warmly. "That's such a sweet thought, Fatima. But do you know the best gift we can give to our parents?"

Fatima shook her head. "What is it?"

"The best gift," Zainab said, "is to make dua for them. Our Prophet Muhammad (SAW) taught us a special dua for our parents. It's one of the greatest ways to show love and gratitude."

Fatima's eyes widened. "A dua? What is it?"

Zainab recited the dua softly: **Rabbir hamhuma kama rabbayani saghira,** which means, "**My Lord, have mercy upon them as they raised me when I was small."**

Fatima repeated the words slowly, savoring their meaning. "So this dua is like asking Allah to take care of our parents, just like they've taken care of us?"

Zainab nodded. "Exactly. It's asking Allah to show them mercy and love for all the hard work they've done."

Fatima felt a warm feeling in her heart. "I'm going to say this dua for them every day. Thank you, Zainab."

The next day at school, during break, Fatima gathered her friends, Asma, Hamza, Yusuf, and Zayd, under a tree. “I learned something really special yesterday,” she said, her voice filled with excitement.

“What is it?” Asma asked, curious.

Fatima smiled. “It’s a dua for our parents. We should say it every day to ask Allah to take care of them, just like they take care of us.” She recited the dua for her friends, and they all repeated it after her.

“That’s such a beautiful dua,” Hamza said. “I’m going to say it for my parents, too!”

Later that day, after school, Fatima rushed home. As soon as she saw her parents, she whispered the dua quietly to herself, feeling grateful for all they did. That evening, each of her friends said the dua for their own parents, too.

When their parents heard the dua, they felt a sense of pride and joy in their hearts. They smiled warmly at their children, feeling blessed to have kids who remembered Allah and prayed for them.

Fatima knew that from that day on, she had a special gift to give her parents—a gift that was filled with love, gratitude, and dua.

The End

The Best Gift for the Prophet ﷺ

It was a Friday afternoon, and Asma, Fatima, and their friends sat together after school, talking about what they had learned that week.

"Asma," Fatima said, "have you ever heard of salawat, sending blessings upon the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ?"

Asma nodded. "Yes, but I don't know much about it. Why is it important?"

Fatima smiled. “My mom taught me about it. She said that sending salawat, or durood, to the Prophet ﷺ is one of the best ways to show our love and respect for him. She told me the Prophet ﷺ said that every time we say it, Allah blesses us ten times in return!”

“Ten times?” Hamza asked, wide-eyed. “That’s a lot!”

Fatima nodded eagerly. “And it’s even more special to say it on Fridays! The Prophet ﷺ told us to send lots of salawat on Fridays because it’s the best day of the week.”

“What’s the durood?” Asma asked.

Fatima recited:
Allahumma salli 'ala Muhammad wa 'ala aali Muhammad,
which means, "**O Allah, send Your peace and blessings upon Muhammad and his family.**"

Everyone repeated it after her, saying the words slowly.

Zayd thought for a moment and asked, "But how do we send it? Is it like making dua?"

Fatima's elder sister Zainab, who had just joined them, explained. "It's kind of like a dua, but it's different because we're asking Allah to bless the Prophet ﷺ and his family. The Prophet ﷺ loved us so much, and this is a way we can show our love back. Every time we say it, Allah rewards us and brings us closer to Him."

“That’s amazing,” Asma said. “I’m going to say it every Friday from now on!”

Later that day, when the children went home, they each told their parents what they had learned about the durood and made a promise to say it often—especially on Fridays.

That night, as Fatima and Asma sat down with their family after Maghrib, their parents smiled proudly as the girls recited the durood. The room filled with peace and a sense of connection to the Prophet ﷺ.

From that day forward, every Friday, the friends made it a habit to send salawat upon the Prophet ﷺ together, knowing that each time they did, they were sending a beautiful gift to the Prophet ﷺ while receiving blessings in return.